

6 Boats on the canal

In this painting of two small boats on a Venetian canal, orange is both the dominant and the underlying color. Because the first layer of orange paint shows through subsequent layers of color in the reflections and shadows, it unifies the different elements of the picture. Lifting out color with a clean damp brush reinstates light areas accidentally lost in the first few washes. This is particularly useful here, as the lighter tones created by lifting out are gently tinted rather than white, so do not detract from the layers of color used to depict the boats.

EQUIPMENT

- Cold-pressed paper
- Brushes: No. 5, No. 9, ½ in (12.5 mm) and 1 in (25 mm) flat
- Raw sienna, cadmium yellow, light red, cadmium red, cerulean blue, burnt sienna, French ultramarine, Windsor violet, burnt umber, alizarin crimson

TECHNIQUES

- Creating shadows
- Lifting out
- Layering



1 Paint the brickwork and water with a raw sienna wash. Make vertical strokes with the 1 in (25 mm) flat brush, letting the wash break in places. Brighten the brickwork with cadmium yellow, adding vertical strokes of light red and soften with water.



2 Mix cadmium red and cerulean blue to make gray for the stairs. Mix cerulean blue and yellow for the water, and paint the water ripples with the edge of the 1 in (25 mm) flat brush. Use cerulean blue to define the edges of the building.

BUILDING THE IMAGE

